

STARTER

Common Reasons Applications Don't Succeed & How to Avoid Them

United Arab Emirates - Tourist Visa

UAE tourist visa applications are decided by the issuing authority (ICP federally, or GDRFA Dubai for Dubai-specific applications) without an interview and, in almost all cases, without a stated reason if refused. This is a genuinely different situation from many other countries covered elsewhere in this catalogue, where a written refusal letter explains the specific ground.

The most common reasons applications don't succeed

1. Passport validity or condition issues

Passports with less than 6 months' validity remaining, or in poor physical condition, are a common, entirely avoidable cause of rejection.

2. Inconsistent or incomplete information given to the sponsor

Since your sponsor submits the application on your behalf, errors in the details you provide them (name, passport number, dates) become errors in the application itself - double-check everything you send your sponsor before they submit.

3. Previous UAE immigration issues

A prior UAE visa overstay, deportation, or entry ban is a serious and often undisclosed-until-discovered problem - these are checked against UAE immigration records directly and can result in an automatic rejection regardless of your current application's quality.

4. Missing or inadequate health insurance

Health insurance covering your stay is a mandatory requirement - failing to arrange it, or arranging cover that doesn't meet the sponsor's or authority's requirements, can hold up or block your application.

5. Sponsor-side issues

Occasionally a delay or rejection relates to the sponsor's own status (an agency's licence, a resident sponsor's own visa status) rather than anything about you personally - this is one more reason to use an established, reputable sponsor (a major airline, a licensed hotel or travel agency).

NO STATED REASON, NO FORMAL APPEAL

Unlike most other countries in this catalogue, UAE tourist visa authorities generally don't provide a written reason for a refusal, and there's no formal appeal process for individual tourist applications. If your application doesn't succeed, your realistic options are to check with your sponsor for any details they were given, correct anything obviously wrong, and try again - often through a different sponsor or channel. See the Refusal & Reapplication Guide (Premium tier).